Ritam

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK · ADVANCED COURSE

The Mind in the Light of Modern and Spiritual Sciences

MODULE 1

Mind Literacy: What Is the Mind?

by Swami Tadananda

- 1.1 What Is the Mind? A First Look
- 1.2 Who Is the One Who Knows?
- 1.3 The Two Faces of What You Are
- 1.4 Stillness and Movement Are Not Two
- 1.5 How the One Becomes the Many
- 1.6 From the Whole to the Threshold of Personhood

© 2026 Ramakrishna Vedanta Centre (NZ). All rights reserved. This handbook is provided for the personal study of enrolled participants of the course. Please do not copy or share it.

Ritam well-being programme · Ramakrishna Vedanta Centre NZ · www.vedanta.nz

Notation and terms used in Module 1

The symbols and Sanskrit terms the six lessons use, with the lessons' own wording and the lesson where each first appears. Use it alongside the lesson pages.

Term	In the lessons' words	First appears
ψ_x	The incoming impression: what is given. Every perception is ψ_x mixed with ψ_m.	1.1
ψ_m	What you bring: attention, memory, mood, expectation. It combines with ψ_x into the ripple you experience.	1.1
antaḥkaraṇa	The inner instrument: the mind seen as a small cluster of inner functions working together, something you use, not something you are.	1.1
manas	The everyday processing mind, the part that receives, sorts and reacts.	1.1
grāhya	"The apprehended": the object-pole of knowing.	1.2
grāhaka	"The apprehender": the subject-pole of knowing.	1.2
empirical "I" (self)	The sense of being a particular person, the I as it shows up in everyday experience; it can itself be observed. Written self with a lowercase s.	1.2
jīva	Named alongside the ahaṁkāra for the empirical "I" (1.2); the individual experiencer, the particular person (1.6).	1.2
ahaṁkāra	The ego-sense (1.2); the I-maker, where the empirical "I" is built and maintained (1.6).	1.2
Self (Ātman, Cit)	Written with a capital S: the awareness in which the empirical "I" appears, Pure Consciousness; the observing, which cannot be made an object.	1.2
Prakāśa	Light, luminosity, that which reveals: awareness as the luminous, knowing aspect.	1.2 (explained 1.3)
Vimarśa	Awareness as living self-presence: self-reflection, self-awareness, self-apprehension, inner pulsation. The dynamic, self-aware aspect.	1.2 (explained 1.3)
Consciousness-Energy	The course's single English term for the two faces of one living awareness: knowing (Consciousness) and dynamic self-presence (Energy). Not two things joined together.	1.2 (explained 1.3)
Śakti	In the Vedāntic vocabulary, the dynamic aspect, the power of the Divine; the same Reality in active expression.	1.3
Brahman	In the Vedāntic vocabulary, the unmanifest Reality, the infinite, self-luminous Consciousness that is the ground of all existence; named with Śakti as the same pair.	1.3
ground	The self-luminous ground in which all experience appears; the stable, knowing, self-luminous aspect.	1.3
viśrānti	Restful presence as the ground of all activity: the capacity to be still.	1.4
Spanda	The inherent throb of awareness itself: the dynamism intrinsic to Consciousness, met in 1.3 as Vimarśa.	1.4
flow	The dynamic, expressive, differentiating aspect: what produces the world of many things, with space, time and causation.	1.5
ground and flow	Two faces of one Consciousness-Energy, not two realities: the same pair named Brahman and Śakti in Vedānta vocabulary, Prakāśa and Vimarśa in Trika vocabulary.	1.3 (explained 1.5)
Māyā	The principle by which the One appears as Many: the principle of differentiation, limitation and relational appearance. Not "illusion" in the sense of unreal.	1.5
buddhi	The faculty of discrimination and decision, one of the four principal functions of the antaḥkaraṇa.	1.6
citta	The field of memory, where patterns are stored and reawakened; the fourth of the four functions.	1.6

Lesson 1.1: What Is the Mind? A First Look

Aim: to begin an honest inquiry into the mind, which we use every moment and know very little about. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 1.1 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what is given (ψ_x) and what you bring (ψ_m) in any act of knowing, and why two people in the same room can have different experiences.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Direct experience	
Map and land	
ψ_x (what is given)	
ψ_m (what you bring)	
Predictions (of the brain)	
Antaḥkaraṇa	
Manas	
Mind as instrument	

3 Fill the gaps

Thought is like a map, and a map is not the _____ itself.

What you actually experience is ψ_x mixed with _____.

The mind is something you _____, not something you are.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Thought is partial, so it is false, and the wise course is to set the mind aside."

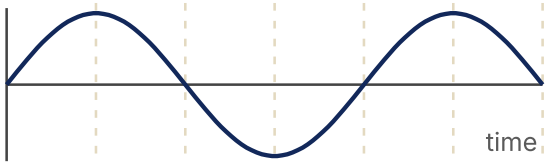
"Two people in the same room experience different things because what is given to each of them is different."

Lesson 1.1: What Is the Mind? A First Look (continued)

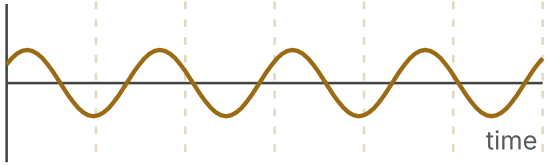
5 Figure 1.1.b

Figure 1.1.b. Every perception is two waves meeting. ψ_x and ψ_m are printed. On the empty axes sketch the single ripple that you experience when the two meet (the dotted lines mark times at which you can add the two heights), and write its name beneath your sketch.

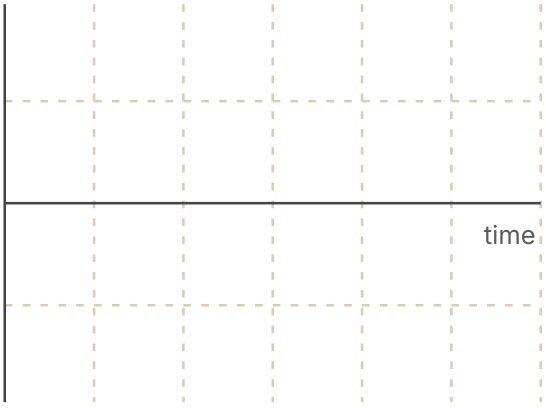
ψ_x: what is given (printed)



ψ_m: what you bring (printed)



Your sketch: the ripple you experience



6 Apply

A friend sends the message, “Can we talk tomorrow?” Maya reads it and feels uneasy. Her brother reads the same words and feels pleased. In the style of the ψ_x-and-ψ_m experiment, say what is present in the bare message and what each of them might be bringing to it.

7 Tracker

Module 1 builds a thread about the ground on which life unfolds. In one line of your own, note what 1.1 adds, for example what the lesson says the mind does not by itself disclose, or what it says is known before thought arrives.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 1.1 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

1.1 What Is the Mind? A First Look

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- We use the mind from waking to sleep, yet most people struggle to say what it is. The lesson calls this a strange asymmetry beside what we know about the body.
- The course aims at a working literacy of the mind, built from the ground up and drawing on two traditions of inquiry: the modern sciences and the spiritual sciences of India. It follows the arc of a medical education across five modules.
- The mind cannot easily examine itself, because examining is itself an act of mind. The way offered is careful attention to experience, not stepping outside the mind.
- Thought is valuable but partial, like a map beside the land. This does not mean thought is false. Often the mind arrives after the event.
- Feeling is real but does not always disclose the situation as it stands. Ethical judgment is necessary, even precious, but it is not the deepest knower.
- Direct experience comes first; thought, feeling and judgment follow as responses, interpretations and formations within experience.
- Every perception is ψ_x (what is given) mixed with ψ_m (what you bring). It is pictured as two waves meeting, and the ripple is not the original wave.
- Two people can have different experiences of the same conversation because ψ_x may be similar while ψ_m differs: memories, moods, histories and attention.
- Whenever you say “I think”, “I feel” or “I judge”, there is a subject and something experienced, and both are themselves known. The lesson says this is not a doctrine and can be verified by looking: there is knowing.
- The mind is an instrument (antaḥkaraṇa, to be studied in Module 2), something you use, not something you are. It is not rejected but resituated, as a powerful instrument within a wider field now open to inquiry.

Terms

ψ_x	What is given: the incoming impression.
ψ_m	What you bring: attention, memory, mood, expectation, history, meaning.
Direct experience	What comes before naming, judging, desiring or explaining.
Antaḥkaraṇa	The inner instrument: the mind seen as a cluster of inner functions.
Manas	The everyday processing mind that receives, sorts and reacts.
Map and land	Thought represents the world; it is not the thing itself.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** land; ψ_m; use.
- **Slips:** thought is partial, not false, and the mind is not rejected but resituated as an instrument; ψ_x may be similar for the two people, and what differs is ψ_m, what each brings.
- **Figure:** look for a single wave that is large and slow where ψ_x dominates, with a smaller, faster wobble from ψ_m riding on it, and that is neither of the two original waves. The lesson calls it the ripple, “what you experience as the situation”. Where both are positive the ripple is higher; where they have opposite signs they partly cancel.

Draft for author review: wording is taken from the lesson text. The lesson names no figure label for the sketch task beyond “ripple”.

1.1 What Is the Mind? A First Look: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 1.2: Who Is the One Who Knows?

Aim: to see, directly in your own experience, that the "I" you ordinarily take yourself to be is itself something you are aware of. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 1.2 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, describe the two poles of every act of knowing, and what happens to the "I" when you notice a statement such as "I am tired".

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Grāhya	
Grāhaka	
Empirical "I"	
Endless regress	
Self with a lowercase s	
Jīva	
Ātman	
Cit (Pure Consciousness)	

3 Fill the gaps

The object-pole was called grāhya, "the apprehended", and the subject-pole was called _____, "the apprehender".

The empirical "I" is the I as it shows up in everyday _____.

The observing is like the eye that sees everything in the room but cannot directly see _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

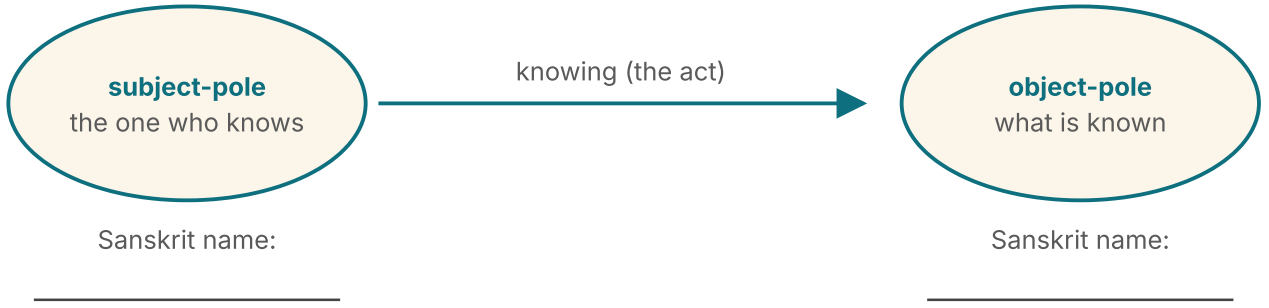
"When I notice 'I am tired', the 'I' is the knower, the one thing that can never itself be observed."

"Since the 'I' turns out to be something I can observe, the particular person I take myself to be must not be real."

Lesson 1.2: Who Is the One Who Knows? (continued)

5 Figure 1.2.a

Figure 1.2.a. Every act of knowing has two poles. Write the Sanskrit name under each pole. Then pick one act of knowing from your day (hearing a sound, for instance) and write in the margin what is the object, what is the act and who is the subject.



6 Apply

Priya is waiting in a queue and thinks, “I am annoyed with that person.” Using the three parts the lesson names (object, act, subject), say what is being noticed, and what the “I” in her sentence turns out to be once she notices it.

7 Tracker

Module 1 builds a thread about the ground on which life unfolds. In one line of your own, note what 1.2 adds, for example what the lesson says about the “I” and about the observing that cannot be made an object.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 1.2 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

1.2 Who Is the One Who Knows?

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- Whenever you say “I think”, “I feel” or “I judge”, the mind has the form of someone knowing something. Both poles can be observed.
- The structure is universal: there is the object, the act and the subject, whether you see a cup, hear a sound, remember or decide. The spiritual sciences of India named the object-pole grāhya and the subject-pole grāhaka.
- The object-pole is easy to identify. The subject-pole is hard to locate; this is not a defect of attention but a first hint that it is not the kind of thing you assumed.
- You ordinarily take yourself to be a particular person: a body, a name, a history, a personality, roles. This sense is the empirical “I”.
- The empirical “I” can itself be observed: once “I am tired” is noticed, the “I” has become one more thing in awareness. So it is not, ultimately, the knower.
- Trying to find the knower, most people meet an endless regress of noticers, or discover that the observing cannot be made into an object. It is like the eye that sees the room but cannot see itself.
- The lesson says what it has not shown: not that you do not exist (the empirical “I” is entirely real), not a mystical vision, and nothing to be taken on faith. If it does not land yet, that is fine; it rewards patience.
- The spiritual sciences distinguish the self (lowercase s: the jīva, the ahaṁkāra) from the Self (capital S: the Ātman, Cit, Pure Consciousness). The Self is not a higher version of the self but a different category: the observing in which the self appears.
- Taking the empirical “I” to be the whole of who you are makes suffering feel total. Seen within a wider awareness, the anxiety is still real, but it has somewhere to be held and is one event within a larger field.
- The lesson calls this an observation to verify, not a doctrine. It does not deny difficult experience; it offers a different relationship to it.

Terms

Grāhya	“The apprehended”: the object-pole of knowing.
Grāhaka	“The apprehender”: the subject-pole of knowing.
Empirical “I”	The particular person you ordinarily take yourself to be, as it shows up in everyday experience.
Self (lowercase s)	The jīva, the ahaṁkāra (the ego-sense): the observable self.
Self (capital S)	The Ātman, Cit, Pure Consciousness: the observing in which the self appears.
Endless regress	A noticer of a noticer of a noticer, where the chain never closes.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** grāhaka; experience; itself.
- **Slips:** once noticed, the “I” has become an object in awareness, so it is not the deepest knower; the empirical “I” is entirely real, and what has been noticed is that it is observable.
- **Figure:** grāhaka under the subject-pole (left), grāhya under the object-pole (right). For the example, for instance a sound (object), hearing (act) and the one who hears (subject).

Draft for author review: the lesson writes “the self, the jīva, the ahaṁkāra” together; the handbook follows that wording and does not separate them.

1.2 Who Is the One Who Knows?: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 1.3: The Two Faces of What You Are

Aim: to see that the awareness found in 1.2 is neither blank nor passive, but luminous and alive. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 1.3 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what Prakāśa and Vimarśa each name, and why the lesson says they are not two separate things.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Prakāśa	
Self-revealing	
Vimarśa	
The felt "I am"	
Consciousness-Energy	
Śakti	
Embodied cognition	
Grooves worn by repeated use	

3 Fill the gaps

Prakāśa names awareness as _____, and Vimarśa names it as living _____.

Light that revealed without being known to reveal would not be awareness; it would be a mechanical _____.

Self-presence without something to be present to would be a closed _____ without content.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Awareness is a silent, inert witness, a still screen on which an illusory world plays."

"Prakāśa and Vimarśa are two stages: awareness first lights things up and only later becomes self-aware."

Lesson 1.3: The Two Faces of What You Are (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

Figure 1.3.c. The lesson's caption reads: “A living, self-shaping mind: patterns are grooves worn by use and can be worn differently.” In the left frame show a pattern as the lesson's first picture sees it (something deposited in a recording device). In the right frame show a pattern as grooves worn by use, and add a second, different groove. Label both.

A recording device	A living, self-shaping mind

6 Apply

Mira has rehearsed her worry about a talk every evening for months, and says, “This is just how my mind is. It was put there and it stays.” Using the lesson's two ways of understanding the mind, say how each would describe her pattern, and what the second suggests about it. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 1 follows one thread, ground and flow. Write one line on what Lesson 1.3 adds about the ground found in Lesson 1.2, using the lesson's own words.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 1.3 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

1.3 The Two Faces of What You Are

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- The observing found in 1.2 cannot be made an object. What is it like: blank and inert, or more? The lesson answers by careful looking, not by argument.
- First feature, luminosity (Prakāśa): experience is known without effort. Like the sun, which is lit by no further light, awareness is self-revealing.
- Second feature, living presence (Vimarśa): a quiet felt "I am" that is not yet "I am anything in particular". A mirror, a screen and a camera lack it.
- The deepest "I am" is not a thought. The empirical "I" develops later (Module 2); the living self-presence does not have to be constructed.
- The two are not separable. Without Vimarśa, illumination would be a mechanical process; without Prakāśa, self-presence would be a closed point without content. Like warmth and brightness in a flame.
- Consciousness-Energy: Consciousness names Prakāśa, Energy names Vimarśa (in Vedāntic vocabulary also Śakti). One Reality with two faces.
- The same pair recurs: Brahman and Śakti, stillness and movement (1.4), ground and flow (1.5), and in Module 4 the spectral and temporal aspects of Ritam. The lesson suggests holding this lightly.
- The course parts from the reading of pure awareness as a still witness against an illusory world: the ground is alive.
- Embodied cognition: meaning is built into perception from the start; the brain anticipates and simulates. This convergence is not proof, and the two framings illuminate each other without reducing to each other.
- A recording-device mind versus a living, self-modifying mind. Neuroplasticity: patterns are grooves worn by repeated use, not permanent verdicts, and can be worn differently.

Terms

Prakāśa	Light, luminosity, that which reveals; awareness as light. Self-revealing.
Vimarśa	Awareness as living self-presence; senses of self-reflection, self-awareness, self-apprehension, inner pulsation.
Consciousness-Energy	The course's term for the one Reality with two faces, Prakāśa and Vimarśa.
Śakti	In Vedāntic vocabulary, the dynamic aspect, the power of the Divine.
Embodied cognition	Research showing meaning is built into perception from the start.
Neuroplasticity	Brain connections and activity change with how the brain is habitually used.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** light, self-presence; process; point.
- **Slips:** awareness is not inert or blank but living, and the world is the expression of a creative, living awareness, not an illusion on a passive screen; Prakāśa and Vimarśa are not two stages but two inseparable aspects of one Reality.
- **Figure task:** look for the first frame showing something stored and left as it is, and the second showing a path deepened by repeated use with a different path worn beside it. Any drawing that shows both ideas is fine.

Draft for author review: wording is taken from the lesson text; the figure task is a free frame because the printed figure was not reproduced.

1.3 The Two Faces of What You Are: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 1.4: Stillness and Movement Are Not Two

Aim: to resolve the tension left by Lesson 1.3 and see that stillness and movement are two faces of one indivisible whole. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 1.4 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say why the lesson holds that deep rest is not inert and that action does not lose its ground.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Brahman	
Śakti	
Spanda	
Presence in action	
Being and Becoming	
Homeostasis	
Dynamic equilibrium	
Viśrānti	

3 Fill the gaps

In Trika, the dynamism intrinsic to Consciousness is named _____, the inherent throb of awareness.

Stillness is what the ocean is; _____ is what the ocean does.

A truly motionless ocean would not be water; it would be _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

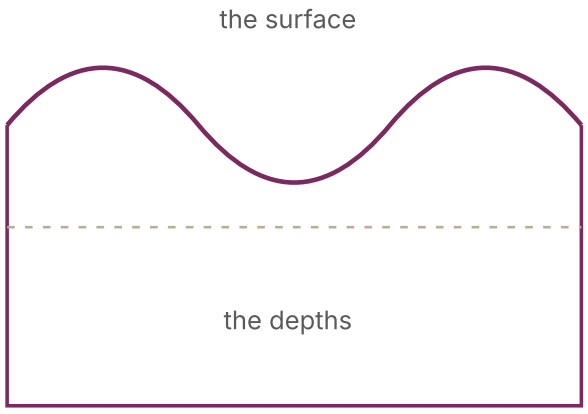
"The deepest rest is perfect stillness, with nothing moving at all."

"A wave is a separate object travelling across the ocean, so movement belongs to the wave and stillness to the ocean."

Lesson 1.4: Stillness and Movement Are Not Two (continued)

5 Complete the figure

Figure 1.4.a. The ocean and its waves. In the sketch below, one bracket marks the surface and one the depths. Beside each bracket write what the lesson says it shows (what the ocean is, what the ocean does), then add one line saying why this is one body of water.



Surface bracket: _____

Depths bracket: _____

6 Apply

Two friends talk. Anna says, “To find peace I must withdraw from life's movement.” Tom says, “If I engage fully with life, I give up inner stillness.” Using the lesson's observation about one breath, say what you would show each of them.

7 Tracker

Module 1 follows one thread, ground and flow. Write one line on what Lesson 1.4 adds to the ground that Lesson 1.3 found to be alive, using the lesson's own words.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 1.4 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

1.4 Stillness and Movement Are Not Two

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- Many people feel torn between a pull toward stillness and life that will not stay still. The lesson says the conflict rests on a misunderstanding: they are two faces of one Reality.
- In deep rest there is still breathing, circulation and subtle awareness; total cessation is death. In action the ground remains. Remove the movement and you have lifelessness; remove the stillness and you have agitation without anchor.
- Advaita Vedanta asks what never changes: Brahman, with Śakti as its own inherent power. Its discernment is not to escape becoming but to stop mistaking the wave for something separate from the ocean.
- Trika finds the ground as the movement, here, as this. The dynamism is named Spanda, the inherent throb of awareness: the dynamism met in 1.3 as Vimarśa. It is not a movement that begins after a stillness.
- Side by side the two emphases illuminate each other, and both point toward presence in action: awareness that is stable and alive at once.
- It is the same pair as Prakāśa and Vimarśa (1.3), here as stillness and movement, Being and Becoming, and in 1.5 as ground and flow.
- A wave is the ocean itself moving. Stillness is what the ocean is, waving is what it does; a truly motionless ocean would be ice. In music, notes arise from, are sustained by and return to silence.
- Homeostasis: stability is achieved through continuous dynamic adjustment, and if the adjusting stops the regulated state collapses within seconds. Dynamic equilibrium and resting-state brain activity show the same pattern.
- The lesson describes burnout, restlessness and anxiety as patterns that arise when stillness and movement are lived as enemies. Viśrānti names the capacity to be still, restful presence as the ground of activity.
- The teaching makes possible a shift in relationship to suffering, not its elimination. Resilience is the ability to return to ground. In one breath most people find that the line between stillness and movement cannot be drawn.

Terms

Brahman and Śakti	Unmanifest Reality and the same Reality in active expression: one fact, two ways of speaking.
Spanda	The inherent throb of awareness, in Trika the dynamism intrinsic to Consciousness.
Presence in action	Awareness that is stable and alive at once.
Homeostasis	A stable internal state achieved through continuous dynamic activity.
Viśrānti	The capacity to be still: restful presence as the ground of all activity.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** Spanda; waving; ice.
- **Slips:** even deep rest has breathing, circulation and subtle awareness, and total cessation is death, not rest; a wave is the ocean itself moving, not a separate object, and stillness and waving belong to one body of water.
- **Figure task:** surface bracket, what the ocean does (waving); depths bracket, what the ocean is (stillness); the water is one, the wave being a form the ocean temporarily takes.

Draft for author review: wording is taken from the lesson text; the sketch in task 5 is a simple drawing made for this handbook, not the lesson's printed figure.

1.4 Stillness and Movement Are Not Two: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 1.5: How the One Becomes the Many

Aim: to follow the flow side of Consciousness-Energy into the lived world, through differentiation and the conditions of space, time and causation. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 1.5 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what Māyā means in this lesson, and why differentiation is not separation.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Māyā	
Differentiation	
The ground	
The flow	
Working distinction	
Binding wall	
Space, time and causation	
Mental time travel	

3 Fill the gaps

Māyā is the way the undivided takes on the form of "this and that" without actually becoming _____.

The three conditions that structure the differentiated world are space, _____ and causation.

The bondage does not arise from difference; it arises from forgetting the _____ within the difference.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Māyā means the world is an illusion, so suffering and ethical life do not really matter."

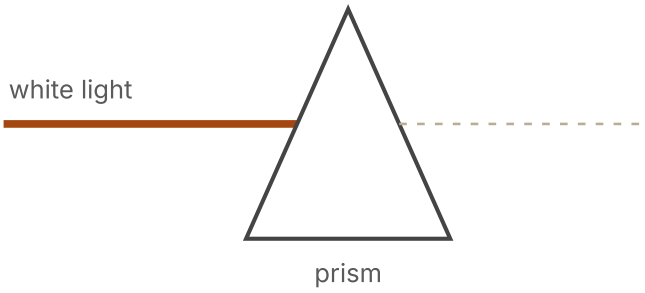
"Space, time and causation are the final nature of the Self."

Lesson 1.5: How the One Becomes the Many (continued)

5 Complete the figure

Figure 1.5.a. White light passes through a prism. On the right, draw the light as it leaves the prism, mark where it spreads into distinct colours, and label them with the lesson's own wording of what each colour is.

Printed: the light and the prism



Your drawing: what leaves the prism

draw and label the light on this side

6 Apply

Tomás remembers a presentation that went badly last year, and tells himself, “That failure is my final identity.” Say which words make a wall, how the lesson would restate them as a working distinction, and where the memory is being put together as he recalls it. Say too what the lesson holds about whether his suffering is real.

7 Tracker

Write one line on what this lesson adds to the module's thread of ground and flow, in the lesson's own words.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 1.5 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

1.5 How the One Becomes the Many

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- The ground (the luminous, knowing awareness) and the flow (what produces the world of many things) are two indissoluble aspects of Consciousness-Energy, with very different characters.
- Māyā is the principle of differentiation, limitation and relational appearance. The lesson says “illusion” is a misleading translation: the world is experienced and cannot be called unreal in the sense of absolute nothingness.
- Differentiation is not separation. The One genuinely appears as Many, yet the Many are differentiated expressions of one indivisible Reality. What is illusion-like is only the misreading that takes relative distinctions to be absolute.
- Differentiation has a useful side (food from poison, one responsibility from another) and a binding side, where working distinctions harden into absolute walls. The work of insight is not to destroy Māyā but to undo the forgetting that absolutises its appearances.
- Space, time and causation structure the differentiated world. They are real and indispensable, but they belong to the flow, not the ground, and are not the final nature of the Self.
- Research on mental time travel, as the lesson reports it, finds that remembering and imagining the future use similar brain networks. Past and future are then present-moment constructions, assembled in present awareness.
- This does not mean the suffering is not real: the lesson says it is entirely real, and that the structure generating it is workable.

Terms

Māyā	The principle of differentiation, limitation and relational appearance; not “illusion”.
Differentiation	The One appearing as Many without becoming divided.
The ground and the flow	Two faces of one Consciousness-Energy: the luminous knowing, and the differentiating, expressive dynamism.
Binding wall	A working distinction taken as absolute, so that the slice is mistaken for the whole.
Space, time, causation	The three conditions through which differentiation becomes an ordered, livable world.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** divided; time; unity.
- **Slips:** Māyā is differentiation, not illusion: the world is real in expression and what misleads is taking relative distinctions as absolute, so suffering and ethical life do matter. Space, time and causation belong to the flow, not the ground, and the Self is not contained by them.
- **Figure:** look for the single light spreading into distinct colours that all start at the prism, and labels that say each colour is the one light, articulated, not a separate thing.
- **Apply:** the wall is “final identity”; the restatement is “this failure at that presentation”. The memory is being reconstructed now, in present awareness; the suffering is entirely real, and its structure is workable.

Draft for author review: wording is taken from the lesson text. The drawing in task 5 is the handbook's own simple line art, not the lesson's Figure 1.5.a. The lesson's claims about depression and anxiety are not used in the exercises.

1.5 How the One Becomes the Many: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 1.6: From the Whole to the Threshold of Personhood

Aim: to draw Module 1's threads together and prepare for Module 2's question: how the universal awareness comes to appear as your particular life. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 1.6 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what Module 1 has shown about the deepest knower and about the empirical "I".

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Ground and flow	
Consciousness-Energy	
Māyā	
Antaḥkaraṇa	
Jīva	
Localisation	
Limitation	
Identification	

3 Fill the gaps

Module 2's answer has three linked movements: localisation, limitation and _____.

In the body and mind analogy, Module 2 is the anatomy and Module 3 is the _____.

Localisation, limitation and identification together produce the _____, the individual experiencer.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Module 1 handed us a set of doctrines to accept."

"The empirical "I" is a foreign metaphysical object that Module 2 introduces from outside."

Lesson 1.6: From the Whole to the Threshold of Personhood (continued)

5 Complete the figure

Figure 1.6.a. The architecture of Module 1 is a path from the living ground to the structured world. Here the first and last steps are printed. Fill in the three steps between, in the order the module built them, and note the lesson where each was met.

Module 1: the path from the ground to the structured world



Write the three missing steps in order, and the lesson where each was met.

6 Apply

Anya has finished Module 1. A friend asks, “Isn't all this just philosophy to believe?” Write what she might say, using what Module 1 asked her to do and one of the three recognitions the lesson names to carry forward.

7 Tracker

Gather the module's thread of ground and flow. For each lesson, write a few words on what it added, in the lesson's own words.

Lesson	What it added to ground and flow
1.1 What Is the Mind? A First Look	
1.2 Who Is the One Who Knows?	
1.3 The Two Faces of What You Are	
1.4 Stillness and Movement Are Not Two	
1.5 How the One Becomes the Many	

8 Check my notes

Key points for 1.6 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

1.6 From the Whole to the Threshold of Personhood

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- Module 1 was a sequence of observations to verify in your own experience, not doctrines to accept.
- The architecture of Module 1: pure awareness as ground; awareness as living, not inert; stillness and movement as inseparable; differentiation as the principle by which the One appears as Many; space, time and causation as the structuring conditions of manifested experience.
- In the body and mind analogy, Module 1 is the foundational orientation, Module 2 the anatomy (the antaḥkaraṇa: manas, buddhi, ahaṁkāra, citta), Module 3 the physiology (the wave-mechanics of perception, thought and feeling, where the ψ_x and ψ_m picture returns), Module 4 the clinical framework, and Module 5 the treatment and prevention.
- The course sets modern science and the spiritual sciences of India in dialogue, and calls the convergences met so far "independent confirmations": embodied cognition and Vimarśa; neuroplasticity and the dynamic aspect of awareness; relativity and the Māyā of space and time; mental time travel and constructed time.
- Module 2 asks how the universal awareness becomes your particular awareness, through three linked movements: localisation, limitation and identification. Together they produce the jīva, the individual experiencer.
- The empirical "I" is not a foreign metaphysical object: it has already been noticed as something observable. The jīva is the empirical "I" examined more precisely.
- Three recognitions to carry, lightly held: the Self is the awareness in which the empirical "I" appears; reality is alive at its deepest layer; the world is real but conditioned.

Terms

Ground and flow	Two faces of one Consciousness-Energy: the luminous, living awareness and its differentiating, structuring dynamism.
Māyā	The principle of differentiation by which the One appears as Many.
Antaḥkaraṇa	The inner instrument, with four principal functions: manas, buddhi, ahaṁkāra, citta.
Localisation	Awareness appearing centred in one body-mind.
Identification	The localised centre taken as the whole of oneself.
Jīva	The individual experiencer, the empirical "I" you ordinarily take yourself to be.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** identification; physiology; jīva.
- **Slips:** Module 1 was a sequence of observations that can be verified in your own experience, not doctrines to accept. The empirical "I" has already been noticed as something observable within awareness (Lesson 1.2); the jīva is that "I" examined more precisely.
- **Figure:** after pure awareness as ground, in order: awareness as living, not inert (1.3); stillness and movement as inseparable (1.4); differentiation, the One appearing as Many (1.5); ending at space, time and causation.
- **Tracker:** 1.2 the "I" is known and what observes cannot be made an object; 1.3 luminous and alive; 1.4 stillness and movement are not two; 1.5 the flow as differentiation and the three conditions.

Draft for author review: wording is taken from the lesson text. The path drawing in task 5 is the handbook's own simple line art, not the lesson's Figure 1.6.a. The lesson's phrase "independent confirmations" is kept; Lesson 1.3 speaks more cautiously of convergence.

1.6 From the Whole to the Threshold of Personhood: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life